

Acute Pharyngitis — Adult OPD

ASSESS

- Sore throat, fever; examine tonsils, cervical nodes
- Centor criteria ≥ 3 suggests streptococcal cause

RED FLAGS — REFER

- Stridor, drooling, trismus (suspect abscess)
- Unable to swallow liquids; toxic appearance

FIRST-LINE MANAGEMENT

- Symptomatic: Paracetamol 500–650 mg every 6–8 h as needed (max 3 g/day adult)
- If streptococcal likely: Amoxicillin 500 mg three times daily for 5 days
- Penicillin allergy: Azithromycin 500 mg once daily for 3 days

DO NOT

- Do not use antibiotics for clearly viral sore throat
- Avoid routine throat swab in low-risk presentation